THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 7 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · HARD LEVEL UNIT TEST SET 1

Chapters 5–8: **Cities and States: The Second Urbanisation, The Rise of Empires, The Age of Reorganisation, The Gupta Era** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 2 Hours Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 50**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–15 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 16–20 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 21–25 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 26–27 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 24–25 and Q. 26–27.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 15 × 1 = 15

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. A historian finds iron tools and punch-marked coins in a layer of a town. This suggests 1

(a) agricultural growth and trade in the Second Urbanisation
(b) Harappan settlement
(c) Mughal settlement
(d) Gupta rule

2. A historian compares Megasthenes' and Kautilya's accounts of Pataliputra. This is useful because 1

(a) independent sources can confirm or challenge each other
(b) both are identical
(c) both are modern
(d) neither is relevant

3. A hoard of Roman gold coins is found in Tamil Nadu. Which conclusion is best? 1

(a) south India traded with the Roman world **(b)** no trade occurred
(c) Tamils ruled Rome **(d)** Romans ruled it

4. A historian relies only on the Prayaga Prashasti for Samudragupta. The major risk is 1

(a) too many dates **(b)** no names
(c) one-sided praise from a court poet **(d)** too little detail

5. If a city lies at the meeting of rivers, its likely advantage is 1

(a) transport and fertile land **(b)** desert climate
(c) no trade **(d)** no people

6. The Lion Capital at Sarnath was chosen as India's emblem because 1

(a) it was a coin
(b) it was a flag
(c) it symbolises strength, courage and dhamma
(d) it was a weapon

7. Which pair is correctly matched? 1

(a) Chola - Madurai **(b)** Chera - Pataliputra
(c) Pandya - Amaravati **(d)** Satavahana - Pratishthana

8. Which statement correctly contrasts Mauryan and Gupta administration? 1

(a) no difference
(b) Guptas had no kings
(c) Mauryas used land grants
(d) Guptas relied more on feudatories and land grants

9. Two mahajanapadas both control iron mines. The more likely outcome is 1

(a) peace without rivalry
(b) no war
(c) no trade
(d) rivalry to control routes and resources

10. Which of the following is a risk of relying only on Indica? 1

(a) Greek ambassador may misunderstand customs
(b) it is a Mauryan record
(c) it is an inscription
(d) it is always accurate

11. The development of Brahmi numerals at Naneghat is important because 1

(a) it shows early development of the decimal system
(b) it is an empire
(c) it is a city
(d) it is a poem

12. Why might Gupta gold coins show kings playing musical instruments? 1

(a) to show farms
(b) to display cultural refinement
(c) to show tax
(d) to show war

13. **Assertion (A):** Mahajanapadas were larger states formed by joining janapadas. 1
Reason (R): Magadha was one of the most powerful mahajanapadas.
Choose the correct option:

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

14. **Assertion (A):** The Ashoka Chakra on the Indian flag has 24 spokes. 1
Reason (R): The chakra is a wheel of dharma taken from an Ashokan pillar.
Choose the correct option:

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

15. **Assertion (A):** Satavahana kings were often named after their mothers, as in Gautamiputra. 1
Reason (R): Queen mother Gautami Balashri recorded her son's achievements in an inscription at Nashik.
Choose the correct option:

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 5 × 2 = 10

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

16. How did coins affect taxation? 2

17. Why are edicts reliable evidence? 2

18. Why are inscriptions at donor sites valuable? 2

19. Why are prashastis not entirely reliable? 2

20. How did trade routes create cities? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 5 × 3 = 15

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

21. Evaluate the importance of iron in state formation. 3

22. Evaluate the sources for the Mauryas and their reliability. 3

23. Evaluate the role of trade in the rise of the Satavahanas. 3

24. Evaluate the Gupta age as a 'Golden Age'. 3

OR

Analyse the effects of surplus on society. 3

25. Assess the impact of Alexander's invasion on Indian politics. 3

OR

Analyse the economic role of ports and sea trade. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

26. **Case study.** Around the sixth century BCE, Rajagriha was a busy capital in the Ganga plain. A strong wall with narrow gateways surrounded it, and traders used silver punch-marked coins in its markets. Officers collected taxes to support the army and the ruler. 5

(i) Of which mahajanapada was Rajagriha an early capital?

(ii) What were the early coins called?

(iii) Why were gateways kept narrow?

(iv) How did taxes help the rulers of these states?

27. Critically examine the changes in politics, economy and culture in India between 200 BCE and 300 CE. 5

OR

Critically examine the nature of Gupta kingship and administration. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 50 Marks

MASTERMIND